

A fat chance of survival

The enormously fat walrus may look ungainly on land, but it is perfectly suited to life in the water. A thick layer of blubber protects it from the icy cold of its home in the Arctic ocean.



A watery haven

The walrus loves the water. It uses its back flippers to push itself forward and its front flippers to change direction.

A walrus's tusk is an extra-long canine tooth.

Walrus tusks can grow to about 3 ft (1 m) in length.

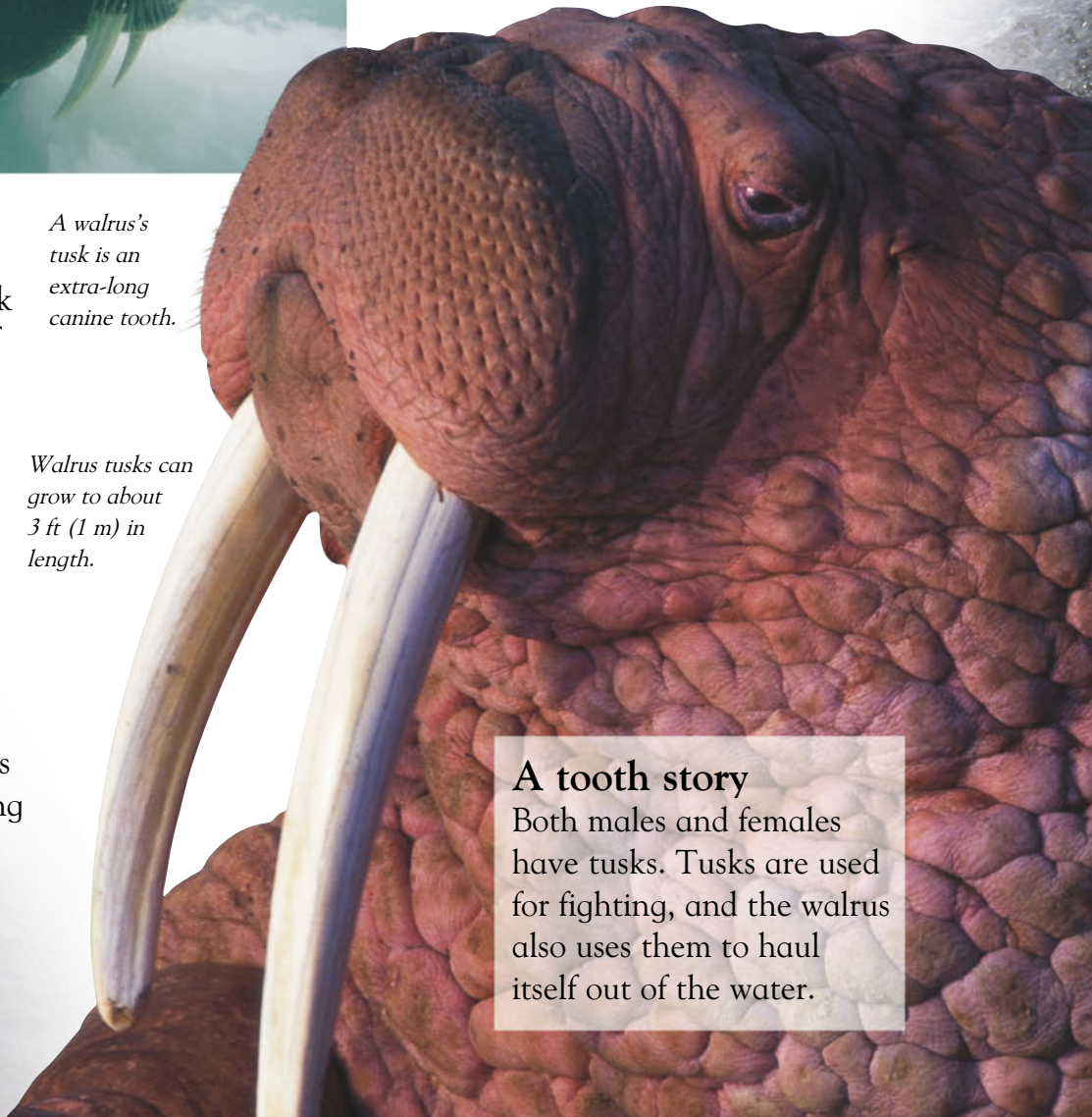
Snuggle up

Walrus colonies are huge, with hundreds of members. It means there's a lot of jostling for position on the beach, but this also helps to keep the walruses warm.



I'll fight you!

Adult males will fight for space to be near females. However, despite looking nasty, these fights rarely result in serious injury.



A tooth story

Both males and females have tusks. Tusks are used for fighting, and the walrus also uses them to haul itself out of the water.